

Your birth partner can provide verbal support to help you deal with the strenuous task of pushing your baby out with each contraction. There may be times when you're not lucid and your partner will need to speak for you and liaise with medical staff.

In addition to emotional support, your birth partner can act as your physical support in whatever position you adopt in the second stage, whether this is a squatting position or another position that you find comfortable. Your partner will be able to massage your back if this is helpful, and can hold you and comfort you and help you focus on your breathing during and between each contraction.

Your partner can also watch as your baby's head crowns and describe what they can see, or hold a mirror for you to see the baby's head, which can be deeply reassuring as you realize that the end is in sight.



THE BIRTH PASSAGE
